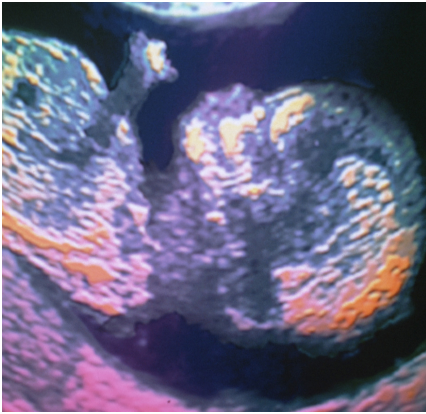




YOU ARE **35 WEEKS AND 3 DAYS**

32 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

In this week, the lungs become almost fully functional and able to support the baby if delivered early. However, the baby at this time is still preterm, and will not be mature enough until 37 weeks to be considered full term.

“Don’t forget this is a life-changing time for your partner, too, so find positive ways to involve them in the time preceding the birth.”

There is, understandably, a lot of focus on the mother in the lead-up to childbirth, but it’s important not to neglect your partner, who may be getting anxious about the birth itself, about how to cope being in the delivery room or just concerned about you being in pain. Some partners feel guilty that they cannot take their share of the pain and help more during labor.

Aside from thinking about the birth, your partner may be anxious about the fact that they will be sharing the responsibility for a newborn baby in just a few weeks!

Talk to your partner if they appear anxious and involve them as much as possible—from helping you cope with pregnancy discomforts to preparing for the birth. If you’ve written a [birth plan](#) (see [Making a birth plan](#)), go back over it now and discuss what might happen and how your partner could help on the day.

You could practice positions and breathing techniques for labor so that they feel more confident about helping you manage. If possible, your partner could go to your final prenatal appointments with you, where they can discuss any concerns with the doctor.

ASK A DOCTOR

Will I be able to love my newborn twins equally? Yes, but it may happen that one baby needs more attention than the other, and it is natural for your time to be diverted to the baby whose needs are not yet met. It is possible that the strain of having two babies may increase the likelihood of delayed bonding, although this can also happen if the birth has been traumatic; if the parents are exhausted; or if one baby has taken time to establish feeding, or is more irritable than the other.

When a parent has two children born at different times, that parent may love one child differently than the other, but this does not mean that the love a parent has for one child is to the detriment of the other. If once your babies are born you still have concerns, speak to your doctor.

FOCUS ON PARTNERS
